

Second Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Secunda Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: charity embodied in the banquet of God

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Fathers and saints	Connection
Introit	<i>Factus est Dominus protector meus</i> (Ps. 17)	Rescue into breadth	St. Ambrose on the Psalms; Cassiodorus on Psalm 17	The Lord does not merely defend; he brings the soul into the wide place of divine charity.
Collect	Fear and love of the holy Name	Holy fear and stable love	St. Bernard on the Name of Jesus; St. Catherine of Siena on holy fear	The prayer joins reverence and intimacy: fear keeps love from presumption, love keeps fear from servility.
Epistle	1 John 3:13-18	Passing from death to life by loving the brethren	St. Augustine, Homilies on 1 John; St. John Chrysostom on almsgiving	Charity must leave the tongue and enter work and truth.
Gospel	Luke 14:16-24	The great supper	St. Gregory the Great, Gospel homilies; St. Bede on Luke	Excuses reveal disordered loves; the poor and broken reveal the gratuitous wideness of the invitation.
Offertory	<i>Domine, convertere, et eripe animam meam</i> (Ps. 6)	Conversion before communion	Desert Fathers on compunction	The banquet is entered by being turned around, not by self-justification.
Communion	<i>Cantabo Domino, qui bona tribuit mihi</i> (Ps. 12)	Thanksgiving for benefits	St. Ignatius of Loyola, gratitude as root of service	The communicant sings because the supper is already gift before it is task.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Luke 14 presents a man making a great supper, the invited guests refusing through excuses, and the poor and wounded being brought in.
Allegorical	The supper signifies the Kingdom and the Eucharistic banquet of the Church, where Israel's call opens into the gathering of the nations and the spiritually poor.
Moral	The hearer must examine respectable attachments that make him refuse grace, then prove charity in deed and truth as 1 John commands.
Anagogical	The earthly invitation anticipates the eternal wedding feast, where every excuse will be exposed and every healed poverty will become joy.

Homily Sketch

Proposition. The great supper is charity offered before it is charity commanded. The soul that has been invited into God's abundance must stop treating mercy as an interruption.

Opening movement. The Introit begins with deliverance into breadth: *eduxit me in latitudinem*. The Gospel shows that breadth as a banquet large enough for the poor, weak, blind, and lame. The narrowness is not in God but in our excuses.

Doctrinal center. The Collect asks for fear and love together. Holy fear hears the summons; love rises and comes. Without fear, invitation becomes cheap; without love, fear never reaches the table.

Moral turn. The Epistle refuses sentimental religion: "not in word, nor in tongue; but in deed, and in truth." The invited man becomes an inviting man, especially toward the brother in need.

Exegetical Notes

- Luke 14 is spoken at table. Christ turns an ordinary meal into an image of the Kingdom and of Eucharistic readiness.
- The excuses are not gross sins. Land, oxen, and marriage are legitimate goods made ultimate.
- The servant's mission widens in stages: invited guests, city streets, then roads and hedges. Grace presses outward.

Witness	Short text	Homiletic use
St. Augustine	"Love, and do what thou wilt." Homily on 1 John	Explain carefully: Augustine means rightly ordered charity fulfills action, not that impulse replaces obedience.
St. Gregory the Great	The poor brought to supper show those whom the proud overlook.	Use Gregory to expose respectable refusals and to honor the hidden guests of God.
St. John Chrysostom	Almsgiving is a concrete test of love for Christ.	Tie the Epistle's "deed and truth" to parish works of mercy.
St. Benedict	Prefer nothing to the love of Christ.	The good things named in the excuses must remain below the supreme good.

Thread	Synthesis
Banquet and almsgiving	The Epistle tests the Gospel. One cannot accept the invitation to the great supper while closing the heart to a needy brother.
Excuses and attachments	Field, oxen, and marriage are goods; they become refusals when treated as ultimate. This is a classic patristic reading of ordered love.
Fear and love	The Collect prevents two errors: servile terror that avoids the table, and casual presumption that ignores the summons.
Church and mission	The servant who announces supper is an image of apostolic preaching: the Church compels by truth, beauty, mercy, and urgency.
Prayer focus	Identify the respectable excuse that keeps charity theoretical, then answer the invitation through one concrete act of mercy.

Preaching Applications

- Name modern excuses without contempt: busyness, family logistics, work, property, reputation, and curated comfort.
- Press the Eucharistic question: do I come to the Lord's table while refusing the brother Christ has seated near me?
- Offer one concrete practice: before Sunday Mass, choose one act of hidden charity for someone who cannot repay it.

Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Secunda post Pentecosten*.
- Suggested patristic study: Augustine on 1 John; Gregory the Great on Luke 14; Bede on the Gospel of Luke.